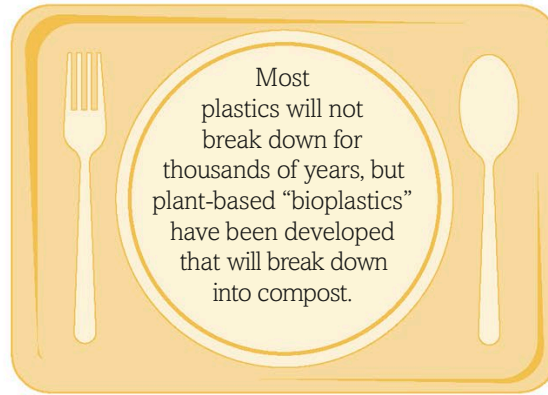


1789

English naturalist Gilbert White describes the time of year that different plants bloom. Today, scientists use this information to study how climate change is affecting flowering times.



Every kernel on one ear of corn is unique and can look different from one another.



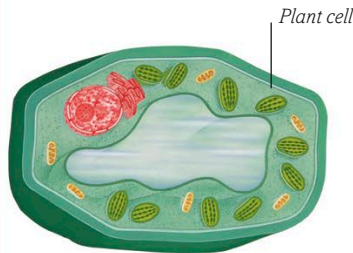
1800s

Austrian monk and scientist Gregor Mendel uses pea plants to explore how plants inherit their characteristics. Like humans, a plant gets half of its characteristics from the female plant and half from the male plant.



1838

German botanist Matthias Jakob Schleiden publishes *Contributions to Phytogenesis*, in which he argues that all plants are made of tiny units called cells.



1983

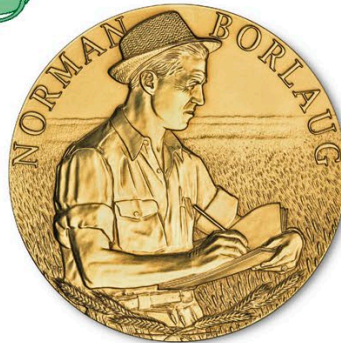
American scientist Barbara McClintock is awarded the Nobel Prize in 1983 for her research into the inheritance of corn (maize) traits and how this is controlled. This work has led to other important discoveries in the field of genetics.

2008

The Svalbard Global Seed Bank is built in Norway in 2008. This building stores seeds from around the world in case they are needed in the future.

1753

Swedish botanist Carl Linnaeus publishes *Species Plantarum*, which establishes the scientific naming system for plant organisms.



1950s

American scientist Norman Borlaug develops a disease-resistant, dwarf wheat variety, which helps feed billions. Before the 1950s, tall wheat plants often blew over before the top-heavy crops could be harvested.



The book contains data on the 5,940 plants known at the time.

